

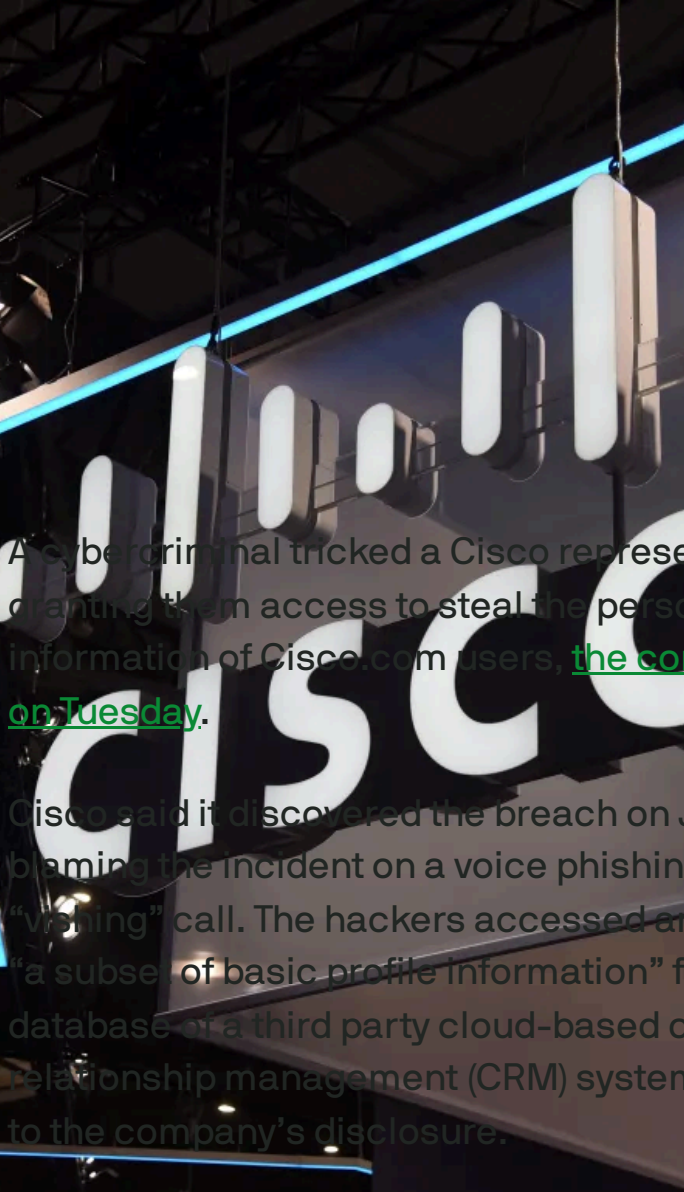
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SECURITY



Hacker used a voice phishing attack to steal Cisco customers' personal information



Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

— 8:03 AM PDT · August 5, 2025

A cybercriminal tricked a Cisco representative into granting them access to steal the personal information of Cisco.com users, [the company said on Tuesday](#).

Cisco said it discovered the breach on July 24, blaming the incident on a voice phishing or “vishing” call. The hackers accessed and exported “a subset of basic profile information” from the database of a third party cloud-based customer relationship management (CRM) system, according to the company’s disclosure.

Cisco said that the stolen data included the customer’s name, organization name, address, Cisco assigned user ID, email address, phone number, and account-related metadata,” such as the account creation date.

The networking tech giant did not specify how many Cisco.com users were affected by the breach. When reached by email, Cisco spokesperson Carro Halpin would not say.

As [Bleeping Computer noted](#), this breach could be another one in a string of attacks that targeted companies’ Salesforce data, including [U.S. insurance giant Allianz Life](#), luxury retailer Tiffany and Co., [Australian airline Qantas](#), and others.

Cisco is a known customer of Salesforce, according [to the cloud giant](#).

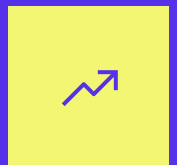
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This story was updated to include a response from Cisco.



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SECURITY



## Hacker leaks millions more 23andMe user records on cybercrime forum

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

— 9:33 AM PDT · October 18, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS:

PAUL MORRIS/BLOOMBERG VIA GETTY IMAGES

The same hacker who leaked a trove of user data stolen from the genetic testing company 23andMe two weeks ago has now leaked millions of new user records.

On Tuesday, a hacker who goes by Golem published a new dataset of 23andMe user information containing records of four million users on the known cybercrime forum BreachForums. TechCrunch has found that some of the newly leaked stolen data matches known and public 23andMe user and genetic information.

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Golem claimed the dataset contains information on people who come from Great Britain, including data from “the wealthiest people living in the U.S. and Western Europe on this list.”

23andMe spokesperson Andy Kill said in an emailed statement that the company was made aware of this new leak today, and that it is “reviewing the data to determine if it is legitimate.”

On October 6, 23andMe [announced that hackers had obtained some user data](#), claiming that to amass the stolen data the hackers used credential stuffing — a common technique where hackers try combinations of usernames or emails and corresponding passwords that are already public from other data breaches.

## Contact Us

Do you have more information about the 23andMe incident? We’d love to hear from you. You can contact Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai securely on Signal at +1 917 257 1382, or via Telegram, Keybase and Wire @lorenzofb, or email [lorenzo@techcrunch.com](mailto:lorenzo@techcrunch.com). You also can contact TechCrunch via SecureDrop.

In response to the incident, 23andMe [prompted users to change their passwords](#) and encouraged switching on multi-factor authentication. On its official page addressing the incident, 23andMe said it has launched an investigation with help from “third-party forensic experts.” 23andMe blamed the incident on its customers for reusing passwords, and an opt-in feature called [DNA Relatives](#), which allows users to see the data of other opted-in users whose genetic data matches theirs. If a user had this feature turned on, in theory it would allow

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hackers to scrape data on more than one user by breaking into a single user's account.

There are still a lot of unanswered questions about this incident. It's not known if the hackers actually used credential stuffing and not another technique to steal the data, how much user data was stolen, and what the hackers intend to do with it.



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The incident appears to have been conducted, or at least launched, several months ago. On August 11, a hacker on another cybercrime forum called Hydra advertised a set of 23andMe user data. That set of user data matched some of the user records leaked two weeks ago, according to a TechCrunch analysis.

On Hydra, the hacker claimed to have 300 terabytes of 23andMe user data, though the hacker did not provide any evidence for this claim.

Regardless of the many unanswered questions, what's clear is that we still don't know the full extent

of this data leak. And it's not clear that 23andMe knows yet how much data was taken.

**UPDATE, October 18, 5:32 p.m. ET:** This story was updated to include the statement from 23andMe's spokesperson.

Read more on TechCrunch:

[RagnarLocker ransomware dark web site seized in international sting](#)

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SECURITY



# Threat actor scraped Dell support tickets, including customer phone numbers

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

9:47 AM PDT · May 14, 2024

The person who [claimed to have stolen the physical addresses of 49 million Dell customers](#) appears to have taken more data from a different Dell portal, TechCrunch has learned.

The newly compromised data includes names, phone numbers and email addresses of Dell customers. This personal data is contained in customer “service reports,” which also include information on replacement hardware and parts, comments from on-site engineers, dispatch

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customer data in as many weeks. Last week, [Dell notified customers that it had experienced a data breach](#), saying in an email that the technology giant was investigating “an incident involving a Dell portal, which contains a database with limited types of customer information related to purchases from Dell.”

The stolen data included customer names and physical addresses, as well as less sensitive data, such as “Dell hardware and order information, including service tag, item description, date of order and related warranty information.”

Dell downplayed the breach at the time, saying that the spill of customer addresses did not pose “a significant risk to our customers,” and that the stolen information did not include “any highly sensitive customer information,” such as email addresses and phone numbers.



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A person who goes by the online handle Menelik claimed responsibility for both data breaches. [In an interview with TechCrunch](#), Menelik provided a sample of the data he stole, which allowed TechCrunch to verify that the data was legitimate. Menelik also provided copies of emails he sent to Dell, and the company confirmed to TechCrunch that it received an email about the data breach from Menelik.

Now, it appears Menelik found another flaw in another Dell portal, which allowed him to scrape more customer data.

“I did find something for email and phone number data,” Menelik told TechCrunch. “But I am not going to do anything with it yet. I want to see how Dell responds to current topic. [sic]”

A day after this article was published, an unnamed Dell spokesperson told TechCrunch that the company is aware of the reports and is investigating.

Menelik said that he had scraped the data of around 30,000 U.S. customers, and said that the flaws he is exploiting are similar to the bugs that allowed him to obtain the first round of 49 million customer records. But this second vulnerability prevents him from collecting the data as quickly as during the first breach.

As TechCrunch first reported, in the first breach Menelik said he was able to scrape Dell customers' data from a portal where he registered several accounts as a "partner," meaning he pretended to run companies that resells Dell products or services. Once Dell approved his requests, Menelik said he was able to brute-force customer service tags, which are made of seven digits of only numbers and consonants.

Menelik posted an advertisement on a well-known hacking forum attempting to sell the data. As of the writing of this article, the listing has been deleted, and Menelik said it's because he sold the data, although he declined to say for how much.

Asked what he plans to do with the new data, Menelik said that he hasn't decided yet.

Given that some of the scraped data contains personal information on customers in the European Union, TechCrunch reached out to Ireland's national data protection authority, which did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

*UPDATE, Wednesday May 15, 2:45 p.m. ET: This story was updated to include Dell's comment.*

## Contact Us

*Do you know more about this Dell hack? Or similar data breaches? From a non-work device, you can contact Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai securely on Signal at +1 917 257 1382, or via Telegram, Keybase and Wire @lorenzofb, or [email](#). You also can contact TechCrunch via [SecureDrop](#).*

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SECURITY



# Hackers steal Activision games and employee data

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

7:55 AM PST · February 21, 2023

Unknown hackers stole internal data from the games giant Activision.

On Sunday, the cybersecurity and malware research group vx-underground [published screenshots](#) of data purportedly stolen from Activision, including the schedule of planned content to be released for the popular first-person shooter Call of Duty.

On Monday, [games blog Insider Gaming](#) said it confirmed a data breach after obtaining “the entirety” of the stolen data, which was not published by vx-underground.

According to the site, hackers stole employee information such as “full names, emails, phone numbers, salaries, places of work, addresses, and more.”

TechCrunch has not been able to confirm the legitimacy of the published data or the details of the breach.

Activision spokesperson Joseph Christinat sent the following statement: “The security of our data is paramount, and we have comprehensive information security protocols in place to ensure its confidentiality. On December 4, 2022, our information security team swiftly addressed an SMS phishing attempt and quickly resolved it. Following a thorough investigation, we determined that no sensitive employee data, game code, or player data was accessed.”

In [a tweet](#), vx-underground wrote that Activision was breached on December 4, after hackers “successfully phished a privileged user on the network.”

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“Also worth noting that the Threat Actor(s) did attempt to phish other employees. Other employees did not fall for the phish. However, it appears they did not report the security incident to the Activision Information Security Team,” vx-underground wrote.

Activision is just the latest victim in a series of hacks against video game companies.

In January, [Riot Games disclosed a breach](#) in which hackers accessed the company's “development environment,” allowing them to steal source code of the popular games League of Legends and Teamfight Tactics, as well as the source code for the company's legacy anti-cheat system.

Earlier in September, hackers [published unreleased footage](#) from the upcoming and much anticipated Grand Theft Auto VI. At the time, the game-maker Rockstar Games admitted that hackers had been able to get their hands on “confidential information from our systems, including early development footage from the next Grand Theft Auto.”

And throughout 2022, a hacking group known as Oktapus (or Scattered Spider) [targeted at least 130 companies](#), according to cybersecurity firm Group-IB. The group gained notoriety for [hacking the cloud communications company Twilio](#), which provides other companies services such as sending automated text messages to their users. Among the around 130 companies targeted there were several game makers, including Riot Games and Epic Games.

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*Do you have more information about this data breach? We'd love to hear from you. From a non-work device, you can contact Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai securely on Signal at +1 917 257 1382, or via Wickr, Telegram and Wire @lorenzofb, or email [lorenzo@techcrunch.com](mailto:lorenzo@techcrunch.com). You can also contact TechCrunch via [SecureDrop](#).*

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